



TailorCV

Installation & Setup Guide

Tailor your resume to any job in minutes using AI

github.com/trendtubedev-lab/resume-builder

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Section 1 — What is TailorCV?

TailorCV is a local web app that uses a panel of four independent AI reviewers — a recruiter, an ATS/keyword specialist, a hiring manager, and an editor — to critique your resume against a specific job description and rewrite it into a single, polished tailored version.

The finished resume can be downloaded as a PDF or Word document. Everything runs on your own computer: your resume is processed in memory and never saved to disk or sent to any third party beyond the AI model you have chosen.

TailorCV supports two modes: using your existing Claude Pro or Max subscription (recommended — no per-use cost), or using an Anthropic API key (a few cents per run).

Section 2 — What You'll Need

Choose one of the two options below. Option A is recommended — it uses your existing Claude subscription with no additional per-use cost.

Option A — Use your Claude Pro/Max plan (recommended)

- Claude Pro or Max subscription — claude.ai
- Node.js 18 or later — nodejs.org (download the LTS installer)
- Python 3.10 or later — python.org

Option B — Use an Anthropic API key

- Anthropic API key — console.anthropic.com
- Python 3.10 or later — python.org

On Windows, when installing Python make sure to tick **"Add Python to PATH"** during the installer.

Section 3 — Download & Install

Step 1: Download from GitHub

Go to the repository and click **Code** → **Download ZIP**, then unzip it anywhere on your computer. Or, if you have git:

```
git clone https://github.com/trendtubedev-lab/resume-builder.git
cd resume-builder
```

Step 2: Install Claude Code (Option A only)

Open a terminal (Windows: PowerShell; Mac: Terminal) and run:

```
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

Verify it installed:

```
claude --version
```

You should see a version number. Then sign in with your subscription:

```
claude
```

A browser window opens. Choose **Subscription** (your Pro/Max account) — not an API key. Once signed in, type **/exit** or press Ctrl+C. You only do this once.

Step 3: Configure

Copy the example config file:

```
Mac/Linux: cp .env.example .env
Windows:    Copy-Item .env.example .env
```

Open **.env** in any text editor (Notepad works on Windows). Set the values for your chosen option:

For Option A (Claude plan):

```
PROVIDER=claude-code
AUTH_DISABLED=1
SESSION_SECRET=any-long-random-string-you-make-up
```

For Option B (API key):

```
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=sk-ant-your-key-here
AUTH_DISABLED=1
SESSION_SECRET=any-long-random-string-you-make-up
```

For **SESSION_SECRET**, just type any long random string — it only needs to exist. Example:
mysecretvalue12345xyz

Step 4: Start TailorCV

Double-click the startup script for your operating system:

```
Windows: double-click start.bat
Mac:     double-click start.command
```

The first run takes about one minute to set up a Python environment and install dependencies. Subsequent starts are fast. When ready, open your browser and go to:

```
http://localhost:8000
```

You should see a **green banner** at the top of the page ("Running on your Claude plan" for Option A, or the reviewer panel ready for Option B). A yellow banner means demo mode — see Section 5 FAQ.

Section 4 — Using TailorCV

1. Upload your resume — PDF, DOCX, or TXT. Up to 3 files at once (useful for uploading multiple versions).
2. Paste the target job description into the text box.
3. Choose a tone: Professional, Impactful, Concise, or Executive.
4. Click **Tailor my resume**.
5. Wait roughly 30–60 seconds while four AI reviewers analyze your resume independently.
6. Review the panel feedback — each reviewer shows a score and specific suggestions — plus the synthesized tailored resume.
7. Download the result as PDF or Word using the buttons at the bottom.

Tip: Click **■ Manage reviewers** at the top of the app to edit any reviewer's focus, add your own, or reset the presets to defaults.

Section 5 — Frequently Asked Questions

Is my resume stored anywhere?

No. Your resume is processed in memory and never saved to disk or sent to any third party beyond the AI model you have chosen.

What file types can I upload?

PDF, DOCX, and TXT files. Up to 3 files at once — useful for uploading different resume versions in the same run.

Can I customize the AI reviewers?

Yes. Click "Manage reviewers" at the top of the app to edit any reviewer's focus, add your own custom reviewer, or reset the presets to defaults.

What does the match score mean?

It is the panel's estimate of how well your original resume matches the job — before tailoring. Use it as a baseline, not a final grade.

Will it make things up about me?

No. TailorCV only rephrases, reorders, and emphasizes what is already in your resume. It will never invent employers, titles, dates, or skills you do not have.

What is demo mode?

If you have not set up a Claude plan or API key, the app runs a lightweight offline preview. The interface works but the results are not AI-generated. Look for the yellow banner at the top.

How much does it cost per run?

Option A (Claude plan): covered by your existing subscription. Option B (API key): roughly a few cents per run using Claude Sonnet (5 model calls per tailoring run).

Something went wrong — what do I do?

Check the troubleshooting table in Section 6 below.

Section 6 — Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
App won't start — "claude not found"	Re-run Step 2 (install Claude Code). Open a new terminal after installing and try again.
"Are you signed in? Run claude once to log in."	Run claude in terminal, sign in with your Claude subscription (choose Subscription, not API key).
Yellow demo banner instead of green	Check .env has PROVIDER=claude-code (Option A) or a valid ANTHROPIC_API_KEY (Option B). Restart the app.
"Timed out" during tailoring	Re-run — usually a one-off. If persistent, add CLAUDE_CODE_TIMEOUT=300 to .env.
start.command won't open on Mac	Right-click the file, choose Open, then confirm in the dialog. Mac security blocks unsigned scripts by default.
Port 8000 already in use	Another app is using that port. Add PORT=8001 to .env and open <code>http://localhost:8001</code> instead.

Section 7 — Stopping & Restarting

- Stop the app:** Press Ctrl+C in the terminal window, or simply close it.
- Restart:** Double-click start.bat (Windows) or start.command (Mac) again.
- Windows quick restart:** Double-click restart.bat — kills any running instance and relaunches.

Questions or issues? Open an issue at github.com/trendtubedev-lab/resume-builder